28th Annual PANTHER SHOOTOUT
AYSO Invitational
Tournament Rules

CATEGORY	RULE
1) **JURISDICTION**	A. Unless otherwise noted, the current AYSO National Rules and Regulations (Section X) and FIFA Laws of the game will be used for this tournament. The following rules are intended specifically for this tournament ONLY. B. The Tournament Committee (Tournament Director, Assistant Director(s), Field Director, Referee Administrator, and other designated staff) will have jurisdiction over all games played. Disputes will be resolved by the end of the soccer day. Referee judgment calls are NOT subject to dispute or protest.
2) **FEES**	A. Entry fee and referee deposit are required with the application and returned if the team is not accepted. Regional checks only, payable to AYSO Region 42 / Panther Shootout; Zelle: psopay@aysoregion42.org. Upload application documents using Document Upload on the tournament website; do not email forms. B. Fees are: a. 10U $600, 12U $650, 14U $700 b. $270 refundable referee fee
3) **ACCEPTANCE**	A. All teams that have submitted an application will be notified 14 days prior to the tournament of their status, and any applications received within 10 days of the tournament will be notified of their status within 72 hours of receipt of the application. B. Teams will be accepted based on tournament needs (see Team Application Form for criteria). Teams will be notified by email within 72 hours of the receipt of their applications. C. Teams not accepted into the tournament will be offered the opportunity to be placed on a waiting list. D. The primary form of communication between the Tournament and applying teams will be the Tournament website. Teams must designate a Team Contact on their registration/application who has email and Internet access.
4) **REFUNDS**	A. Teams withdrawing at least 30 days before the start of the tournament will be issued a full refund. B. Teams withdrawing less than 30 days before the start of the tournament will only be issued a refund if a replacement team can be found. C. If the tournament is canceled and cannot be rescheduled, a full refund will be issued.
5) **RAINOUT/ CANCELLATION**	A. If rained out on the original dates, the tournament will be rescheduled to Sunday, November 29, 2026. All teams will be expected to return on that date to resume the tournament. Any team not able to return will only receive a refund if a replacement team can be found, less the costs of any pre-ordered items. Pre-ordered items will be sent to the team. B. If the tournament has begun but is canceled due to weather and cannot be rescheduled, prorated refunds will be issued to teams based on the number of actual games played. C. If the tournament cannot be held due to weather or other conditions beyond the control of the tournament hosts, then a full refund will be sent to all teams, less the cost of any pre-ordered items. Pre-ordered items will be sent to the team.
6) **PLAYERS/TEAMS**	A. Players on participating teams must be currently registered with AYSO. Coaches/Registrars are responsible to ensure that all players meet eligibility requirements. B. The team roster must be verified and approved by each player's Regional Commissioner. Roster changes may be submitted (with written approval of the Regional Commissioner); however, these changes must be received by the Tournament Registrar prior to tournament check-in. Only SportsConnect rosters are accepted. C. Three (3) Guest Players (players from a different region from the applying team's region) will be allowed for each team. However, the Guest Player will be required to have the approval of both the Guest Player's Regional Commissioner and the Host Team's Regional Commissioner (see Guest Player Form).

	D.	Division 14U will play 11-v-11, and there will be a roster limit of 15 players per team. Division 12U will play 9-v-9, and there will be a roster limit of 12 players per team. Division 10U will play 7-v-7, and there will be a roster limit of 10 players per team.
	E.	All players must play at least half of each game. Violation of these player rules exposes a team to protest and renders them subject to forfeiture of game and possible disqualification at the discretion of the Tournament Director.
	F.	An individual player may not be on more than one roster or play for more than one team.
7) **COACHES**	A.	Each team must have and are limited to one Head Coach and one Assistant Coach. These coaches must be the ones listed on the Official Team Roster.
	B.	Each Coach must be a currently registered volunteer with all volunteer certifications up-to-date as of tournament play dates, and must have a coach certification for the age level they will be coaching.
	C.	Coaches are expected to set an example at all times by exhibiting proper AYSO behavior and adhering to the Kid Zone pledge. Coaches are expected to remain in the technical area (within ten yards either way from midfield) during games and only enter the field of play if requested by the referee.
8) **REFEREES**	A.	There is a $270 refundable referee deposit. Each team should submit three or more qualified referees using the Referee Nomination Form. Referees must subsequently register on the tournament website. The full deposit is refunded for nine completed assignments, including qualifying standby assignments. For fewer than nine completed assignments, the refund is prorated at $30 per completed assignment. Teams completing no assignments receive no referee deposit refund.
	B.	All referees must be currently registered AYSO volunteers and must have all certifications up-to-date as of tournament dates.
	C.	Only the diagonal system of control will be used to referee the games. (CR and 2 AR)
	D.	Referees for 14U games should be Advanced level or above. Referees for 12U games should be Intermediate level or above. Referees for 10U games should be Regional level or above
	E.	Players in the tournament will not be allowed to referee.
	F.	Referees will be expected to uphold the tournament rules, AYSO guidelines, and FIFA laws. Any willful failure of the referee to uphold these rules may be cause for dismissal from the tournament.
	G.	StandBy referees could be asked to act as field monitor for the time assigned in their match. They will receive the radio and will communicate with Referee HQ if any issues arise.
9) **FIELDS**	A.	All fields will be set up and taken down by the tournament staff and volunteers.
	B.	Trash cans will be provided at each field. **Teams will be expected to clean up all trash in their area before leaving**.
	C.	NO PETS ARE ALLOWED! For the safety of our players as well as the animals, pets are NOT allowed anywhere in the Peppertree Park during the tournament. The only animals allowed are service animals that are approved by the Americans with Disability Act (ADA). Emotional Support and Therapy animals are NOT covered by the ADA and are NOT allowed. The coach has to inform Tournament Staff that Service Animal will be present on the sideline 1 day prior to the tournament. Unreported Dogs or Restricted animals on the side line will result in 2 point deduction to the team and ejection of the pet owner.
10) **FORMAT**	A.	This is a pool-play tournament.
	B.	Each age division will be bracketed into playing pools. Each team will play a minimum of 3 preliminary games within their respective pools. Where there are sufficient teams, divisions will also be separated into multiple competition flights.
	C.	Teams will advance from qualifying pools based on pool play standings points. The number of teams advancing per pool will be determined by the number of pools in the division.
	D.	The 8 team division has 2 pools of 4 teams, 1st place team in each pool play in the final, 2nd place team play in consolation. Winners are decided by KFPM. No added time.
	E.	The 6 team division has 2 pools of 3 teams. 3rd place teams in each pool face each other - this match can end in a tie. The 1st and 2nd place teams play a semi final match against 2nd and 1st team in another pool respectively. The winner of the semifinal moves on to the final, loser to consolation. Semifinal and final winners are decided by KFPM. No added time.
	F.	The 5 team division plays 4 games each in round robin format. No KFPM. No added time.
	G.	The 4 team division plays 3 games each in round robin. 1st and 2nd place play in the final. 3rd and 4th play in consolation. KFPM in the final round. No added time.
	H.	KFPM. The max number of shooters is the same as the number of players that would normally be on the field (e.g., a 10U team can have 7 players shoot, while a 14U team can have 11). If a team is playing short,

	the opponent can only select the same number of players to shoot. All players must shoot before any player can go a second time from the selected number of players.
11) **SHOOTOUT COMPETITION**	A. At the end of each of the three preliminary games in tournament play, the two teams that have just played will compete in the Panther Shootout "Kicks from the Penalty Mark" contest to determine a Panther Shootout Champion. The team that loses the qualifying game will decide on going first or second for the shootout. If the qualifying game ends in a tie, a coin toss will be used with the visiting team (second team listed) making the call. B. Each 10U-14U team will send five (5) shooters to the mark at the end of each pool play match. Shooting order will be as submitted by the coaches at the initial team check-in on the white PK lineup card. The order of players may not be altered. All players will shoot at least once during the tournament in the overall order submitted. C. If there are less than 15 players on a team, the shooting order will start over from the top of the PK lineup card and continue down as needed. D. The winners of the PK Shootout portion of the tournament will be decided by total goals scored on kicks from the penalty mark. E. Shootouts are per FIFA rules. Referee decisions are final. F. Tiebreakers for the PK Shootout will be determined as follows: PK goals allowed. Sudden victory shootout. Coaches may submit a new kicking order for players in an extended Shootout format. G. The outcome of the PK Shootout portion of the tournament will have no impact on the standings of the traditional tournament. They will be scored separately.
12) **CHECK-IN**	A. Coaches must check in 60 minutes prior to their first game, and must present game cards for as many games as the team will play in the tournament (including medal-round games and one card for the Shootout). The game cards must be properly completed with the players listed by first name-last name in **jersey number order**. The players listed on the game cards must match the approved roster submitted with the team's application. Players do not need to attend Coach check in. B. Each coach must provide AYSO Player Registration forms with original ink signatures or e-signed signatures for verification by tournament officials. C. Each coach must have these Player Registration forms with them at all times and ready for presentation to Tournament Officials. D. Late arriving players must be checked in by the Tournament Staff before participating in any games.
13) **FIELD MONITORS**	A. There will be a tournament Field Monitor assigned to each field, and will report to the Tournament Field Director. B. At the conclusion of the game, the match referees must return the completed game cards to the Field Monitor. C. Field Monitors will be the first to respond to any incidents or injuries, and will be in contact with the rest of the tournament staff by radio. Tournament participants are encouraged to report any concerns immediately to the Field Monitor, and also to respectfully follow any instructions given by the Field Monitor.
14) **GAMES**	A. Pool play games will be played with game duration as described below with a five minute half time. There will be a running clock during the match, including for substitutions. There will be no time added on for injuries or time wasted in qualifying rounds. Games are expected to end on time, and may be shortened if they start late. Pool play games may end in a tie. B. Championship games will be full length for that division (see chart below). Championship games will be played until there is a winner (see Medal Round rules below). C. Game duration shall be as follows: Division — Pool Play & Semis — Final Rounds 10U: — 24 minute half — 25 minute half 12U: — 25 minute half — 30 minute half

	14U: 25 minute half 35 minute half D. The "home" team will be the first team or top team listed on the game schedule and will be responsible for providing the game ball(s). The home team will be situated on the side of the field closest to the snack shack at Pepper Tree Park. Spectators must remain on the side of the field designated for their team. If the referee determines it is necessary, the home team will change jerseys or use pinnies in the event of a color conflict with the visitor team. E. There may be no warming up on the field in order to stay on time. Teams should warm up prior to taking the field, but can use field space for warm up as available. As soon as the previous game has ended, teams must clear the field so that the next game can begin immediately. F. FORFEITS: There will be a five-minute grace period at the start of the game for a team to take the field before a forfeit is declared. The score for a forfeit match will be 1-0 for the remaining team (See STANDINGS for the points to be awarded).In order for a game to proceed, a team must have the following minimum number of players: 10U - 5 players; 12U - 6 players; 14U - 7 players. If a team cannot field the minimum number of players, the game will be abandoned and a forfeit will be declared. If it is known in advance that a forfeit will occur due to a last minute withdrawal of a team, the other team will be notified and will not have to report to the field to record the win. G. SUSPENDED GAMES: The Tournament Committee may determine to end matches early if field schedule is behind due to game delays, interference, or if weather conditions provide unsafe conditions; and may distribute awards according to games played and points. The Tournament Committee will determine the outcome of any single game which is terminated prematurely (due to inclement weather, participant injury, or interference by outside party, etc.). H. ABANDONED GAMES: If any pool play games cannot be played due to circumstances beyond the control of the tournament, the final standings of the pool will be determined by applying the Winning Percentage formula (Total Points Earned in all Game(s) Played divided by Total Points Possible for the Number of Games Played) to each team in the pool. Note: this does not apply to games which were shortened due to a late start. Only the Tournament Director or designee can declare a game to be abandoned or not played.
15) **SUBSTITUTIONS**	A. Substitutions shall be allowed approximately mid-way through each half for ALL divisions 10U through 14U, and will be recorded on the game cards by the referee. B. All substitutions must be approved and recognized by the referee. Substitutions may be made for injured players; however, the injured player may not return to play until the beginning of the next quarter and will be considered as having played the current quarter (exception: an injured player not replaced may return to play at any time with the referee's permission). C. No overtime periods are played. Tied medal-round matches are decided by kicks from the penalty mark.
16) **STANDINGS**	A. Standings for pool play games will be determined on the "ten-point system" as follows: WIN = 6 points TIE = 3 points LOSS = 0 points GOAL = 1 point (one point per goal scored up to a maximum of 3 per game, win, lose or draw) SHUT OUT = 1 point FORFEIT = 7 points (scored as a 1-0 win, no shutout points as it is not an "earned" shutout) RED CARD = 2 point deduction for team (includes 2 point for each player, substitute or coach) YELLOW CARD = 1 point deduction for team (includes 1 point for each player, substitute or coach) B. Winners of ties in standings will be determined as follows: Head to head competition (omitted in 3-way tie) Most number of wins (If a forfeit game exists for any reason, number of wins or goal differential will not be used to determine the winner) Least number of red cards, then yellow cards Goals allowed – total (up to a maximum of five per game; fewest number advances) Goal differential (goals scored to three per game less total goals allowed; highest differential advances) FIFA kicks from the penalty mark. Coin toss at the end of pool play C. Wild card teams will be the team(s) with the highest standings points from all teams in the division who are not automatically advancing. D. Standings will be updated hourly at the Tournament Scoreboard located at the Snack Shack. The deadline to challenge the posted results will be at the conclusion of Pool Play.
17) **ADVANCEMENTS**	A. Pool winners (and in some cases wild card teams) will advance to medal round play. B. Teams will play championship or consolation matches, depending on the number of teams in each pool and the format of play for that flight.

18) **MEDAL-ROUNDS**	A. All final matches ending in a tie will be decided by FIFA kicks from the penalty mark. No OT period.
19) **AWARDS**	A. Medals will be presented to coaches and players from the teams in the Final game, first-place and second place only in each division. Consolation game participants do not receive medals. B. A tournament pin will be presented to each player and coach.
20) **CONDUCT**	A. Coaches will be expected to set a positive example for the team, and will be held responsible for the actions of their team, including spectators. All spectators must remain behind the control line and between the 18-yard lines. Only one Head Coach and one Assistant Coach maximum per team are allowed on the sideline and they must remain in the technical area (within ten yards either way from midfield) at all times. They are not to enter the field of play at ANY time unless requested by the referee. B. At the conclusion of each match, the referees will indicate on the reverse of the game cards any point deductions for poor sportsmanship. Point deductions will be used as tie-breakers should that become necessary. Referees will be required to complete a game misconduct report for <u>all</u> misconducts during the game, as well as any incidents of interference by spectators. C. Any coach or spectator ejected must immediately leave the vicinity of the playing field (out of sight and sound) and will be prohibited from attending the next scheduled game. Any player sent off (red carded) must immediately leave the vicinity of the game (under supervision of their parent or Safe Haven-certified adult), and may not return to the field of play during the current game, including for the post-game handshake, and may not be substituted for, and will be suspended from participation in the next game. There will be penalty point deductions for all send-offs (see Standings rules). D. Any red card given for violent conduct, or ejection, will result in that player/coach/spectator being barred from the remainder of the tournament. E. If it is determined that an ineligible player has participated in a game, the team will forfeit all games in which that player participated illegally. Furthermore, if it is determined that the Coach knowingly played a player illegally, that Coach will be barred from further participation in the tournament. F. It is mandatory to play a scheduled game. If it is determined that a Coach willfully fails to have his team participate in a scheduled game, the Coach will be dismissed from the tournament and the incident will be reported to the respective Regional Commissioner. G. All conduct problems will be reported to the respective Regional Commissioner. H. All serious Incidents will be reported to the respective Regional Commissioner as well as Area, Section, and AYSO National Office parties.
21) **MEDICAL/FIRST AID**	A. There will be a First Aid station at the main tent where participants may receive bandages,ice, etc. for minor injuries. B. There will be a roving first aid response staff member to respond to injuries on the field. Field Monitors will communicate via radio to call the first aid staffer to the field where first aid is requested. C. If an injury is serious, the first aid staffer or Safety Director will have a mobile phone to call 911 for emergency response. D. Directions to the nearest hospital/urgent care center will be available at the First Aid station.
22) **UNIFORMS/SAFETY**	A. All players must wear the approved AYSO uniform only, and all players on the same team must wear matching uniforms (except goalkeepers, who may have a different jersey, which is recommended to have the AYSO logo, but is not required). B. Each player's uniform must be marked with a permanently-affixed unique number that matches the uniform number on the Game Card, and may not exchange numbered jerseys with any other player during the game, including the goalkeeper. C. Garments may be worn under the uniform (i.e. long sleeves, etc.) during inclement weather, however the match referee will be the judge of what will or will not be allowed. D. Jewelry, casts, and splints of any kind, hard metal or plastic clips on clothing or in hair will not be allowed. If a player arrives at a field with a cast or splint of any kind and is observed by the referee staff or Tournament Staff removing the item, the player will not be allowed to participate in games. E. AYSO will not prohibit the use of knee braces by players in AYSO events and programs provided that the brace is adequately covered and padded in the judgment of the referee, so as to eliminate the possibility of its causing injury to the other players on the field. F. Properly sized shin guards are mandatory and must be worn under the socks.
23) **PROTESTS**	A. Protests will be considered only for the following reasons: ● An ineligible player has played. ● One or more registered player(s), present and in uniform, have not played the required one half of the game (except for illness or injury as recorded by the game referee). B. All protests must be presented in writing to the Tournament Director within 30 minutes of the completion of the game.

	C. All protests will be heard by a Protest Committee of at least three persons selected by the Tournament Director. In all cases, the members of the Protest Committee will be unrelated to either team involved in the protest. **ALL PROTEST DECISIONS ARE FINAL!** D. Referee judgment calls are **FINAL** and are not grounds for nor subject to protest or dispute!
24) **RULES INTERPRETATION**	The Tournament Director retains the right to interpret and apply the tournament rules to the optimum benefit of all tournament participants.